EA HOSPITALITY PULSE

Daily intelligence for city, bush & beach properties across East Africa

Sunday Foresight

2026-10-18

Rwanda won Formula One for the 2030s in the week its prices ran 17.2% above last year's, and East Africa's 2027 cost base now spans 4.3% to 17.2%

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This week the region sold the next decade. Formula One signed Rwanda for ten years, circuit due early next decade (13 Oct). EAC ministers adopted a 2027–2036 marketing strategy (15 Oct). The same week's statistics describe 2027: urban inflation of 17.2% in Rwanda (NISR, September), 6.8% in Kenya (KNBS, 30 Sep) and 4.3% in Tanzania (NBS, 8 Oct).

What everyone is missing: nobody sets the cost bases side by side. Rates are quoted in dollars; payroll, power, fuel and food are paid in local currency. A 13-point inflation gap is a margin gap on the same US$ rate, unless the exchange rate offsets it. We hold no Rwandan franc data to say it does (our inference).

THE WEEK'S SIGNALS

1 RWANDA'S PRICES ARE RISING FOUR TIMES AS FAST AS TANZANIA'S

Rwanda's urban CPI was 17.2% in September, up from 15.7%; national CPI was 20.0%. Restaurants and hotels rose 18.9% on the year and the energy index 45% (NISR, reported 12 Oct). Tanzania held at 4.3% (NBS, 8 Oct). Uganda's latest found is 4.1% for August (4 Sep).

So what: put a cost-review date in 2027 Rwanda contracts; price Tanzania as the low-cost base.

City, Bush | | Confirmed (figures) / Inference (margin read) | impact:margin

2 KENYA'S DIESEL COST ROSE WHILE ITS POWER CHARGE EASED

Diesel is KSh227.76 a litre to 14 Nov, up KSh9.90 (EPRA, 15 Oct). Fuel VAT stays 8% for 90 days (Assembly, 14 Oct). October's power add-ons are about KSh4.10 a unit, from KSh4.16 (EPRA, 9 Oct).

So what: budget transfers on diesel, not power, until the 14 Nov review.

All segments | | Confirmed (figures) | impact:margin

3 THREE DECADE-LONG PROMISES, ONE UNDECIDED VISA

F1 gave no start year (13 Oct). The EAC single-visa study is due 20 Oct, comments by 30 Nov (EAC council, 15 Oct). Marriott's 18-suite Serengeti camp is dated: November.

So what: underwrite 2027 on dated demand only; treat F1 as 2030s upside.

City, Bush | | Confirmed (announcements) / Inference (weighting) | impact:watch

4 KENYA'S THIRD EBOLA CASE CAME FROM A QUARANTINED CONTACT

A 65-year-old woman in quarantine tested positive; 127 of 130 contacts are traced and Kenya says it is open with no travel restrictions (MoH, 16 Oct).

So what: tell guests the checks (digital forms, screening) before arrival.

City, Bush | | Confirmed (statements) | impact:risk

5 TANZANIA'S ADVISORY EASED ON TOP OF A RECORD ZANZIBAR AUGUST

The US cut Tanzania to Level 2 on 16 Oct. Zanzibar took 124,481 visitors in August, up 18%, with bed occupancy estimated at 92.9% (OCGS, 8 Sep; an older release).

So what: reopen US quotes for Tanzania; hold Zanzibar peak rates.

Bush, Beach | | Confirmed (figures) | impact:demand

Blind spots: German and French Kenya advice, UK pages for Uganda, Tanzania and Rwanda, four gazettes, Rwanda's and Zanzibar's health ministries, and KNBS August arrivals were not confirmed.

30/90-DAY DEMAND CALENDAR

20 Oct — EAC visa study due. Don't sell it.

9 Nov — Tanzania October CPI (our 11 Oct edition). Check the gap.

14 Nov — EPRA review; diesel cap runs to here.

about 10 Nov — Rwanda October CPI (release pattern). Review contracts.

30 Nov — EAC visa comments due.

If costs run at three speeds, why does one rate card cover them?

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